CONCEPT DOCUMENT • FULL NARRATIVE EDITION

RWANDAN SKILL-GAMES PLATFORM

Igisoro · Dame · Biyari

Play. Relax the mind. Compete with skill. Meet people.

Purpose of this document. This is a detailed English-language written explanation of the Rwandan Skill-Games Platform concept. It records the features, operating principles, formulas, examples, proposed safeguards, business model, development sequence, and unresolved questions in the underlying concept document. It is written in continuous explanatory prose wherever practical, rather than relying only on short bullet points.

Status. This remains a concept document. It does not mean the platform has already been built, that the technical details are final, or that real-money features have received legal approval.

Document detail	Description
Version	Expanded narrative edition based on Concept Document v1.0
Date of source concept	28 October 2026
Working name	Rwandan Skill-Games Platform; final brand name not yet chosen
Primary games	Igisoro, Dame (draughts/checkers), and Biyari (eight-ball pool)
Language of this edition	English

Core idea in one paragraph. The platform is an online place where real people play Igisoro, Dame and Biyari against one another in real time. Before playing, they agree how many inka each will stake. As the game progresses, the inka balance between the two players changes gradually according to a published mathematical rule. A player can stop at any time and keep the amount shown by the current standing. Other users may watch public games, comment among themselves and request to challenge a player later, but spectators cannot bet on the result.

How to read this document

The source concept distinguishes between decisions already recorded, ideas suggested for consideration, and matters that remain open. This edition preserves that distinction. A statement that is described as a proposed safeguard or suggested feature should not be mistaken for a final confirmed requirement. Likewise, a question listed as open has not been silently answered in this document.

Status	Meaning in this document
Recorded concept / decision	A feature or principle described as part of the agreed concept in the source document.
Suggestion	An enhancement or good-practice measure suggested in the source, but not confirmed as a final rule.
Open question	A matter that must still be decided, specified or checked before implementation.
Illustration	A sample number or story used to explain the concept; it is not necessarily a final price, limit or rule.

Contents

1. Executive summary

2. Vision and guiding principles

3. The three games and scope

4. Skill-based, human-versus-human play

5. Finding opponents, availability and scheduling

6. Inka: the unit of play and value

7. Stakes, advantage and settlement mathematics

8. Live games and spectators

9. Profiles and community

10. Business model and revenue

11. Fair play, fraud prevention and user safety

12. Legal and regulatory considerations

13. Technical considerations

14. Development sequence

15. Open questions

Appendix A. Example of a typical user session

Appendix B. Glossary

Appendix C. Decision log

1. Executive summary

The Rwandan Skill-Games Platform is conceived as an online meeting place for three games: Igisoro, Dame and Biyari. It is intended to let people play from their phones or computers, in real time, against other people rather than against computer-controlled opponents. Some users may already know one another, but the platform is also intended to connect people who have never met and who may live in different places.

Each game uses a unit called an **inka**. In the source concept, the word refers to the small playing pieces, seeds or balls used in the games, not to cattle. On the platform, the same word is used for the unit that players stake and

hold in their account balances. Before a game starts, the two players agree the number of inka each will stake. The stakes do not have to be equal.

The central feature is that the inka do not all transfer only at the very end of a game. Instead, the platform continuously evaluates the state of play and gradually changes each player's current holding as one player gains or loses an advantage. The calculation follows a fixed mathematical rule. If a player stops, the game is settled according to the current standing. The player is free to leave; the other player cannot force them to continue.

The concept treats the games as contests of skill, not chance. There are no bots and no computer opponents. The stated purpose is relaxation, friendly competition, showing one's ability and meeting people. Although the later model allows inka to be purchased and redeemed for money, earning money is described as secondary to playing, and the platform's revenue is intended to come from its inka price spread and advertising rather than from taking a share of who wins.

A new platform would initially launch with all features free, including inka and live viewing. The first game to be built is Dame, which is intended to establish shared systems for accounts, matching, stakes, settlement and live viewing. Igisoro and Biyari would follow. Real-money payment features and identity checks would be introduced later, after the initial free phase; the source concept records that legal and regulatory questions must be examined before real-money features are introduced.

The platform at a glance

Area	Explanation
Purpose	A social and competitive online platform for traditional and familiar games.
Players	Two real people per game; no bots or computer opponents.
Games	Igisoro, Dame and eight-ball Biyari.
Unit of play	Inka, agreed as stakes before the game and redistributed gradually by the settlement rule.
Ways to find opponents	Play-now matching, published availability, scheduled games, reminders and requests from spectators.
Public viewing	Spectators can watch and comment to one another; they cannot bet.
Player view	The players see the game and their running standing, not spectators' comments during play.
Revenue	A fixed difference between the inka purchase and redemption prices, plus advertising outside the live-game page.
Launch	Everything is free at first; payment features are introduced later.

2. Vision and guiding principles

The vision is to create a place where people can relax their minds, demonstrate their skill, and meet new people through games they already enjoy. The platform is not described merely as a digital version of a board game. It is also intended to create opportunities for social contact, friendly competition and a community of players.

2.1 Skill rather than chance

The games are selected because the concept treats success as a result of a player's ability. A person who understands Biyari better than an opponent, or who is more skilled at Igisoro or Dame, may win because of that skill. The platform is therefore intended to avoid games whose results are primarily determined by chance. This principle is central to the identity of the concept, although the legal classification of a real-money version still needs qualified review.

2.2 People rather than machines

Every match is intended to be between two human beings. Computer opponents and bots are not allowed. The source concept says that introducing bots would weaken the distinction between a genuine skill contest and a computer-generated experience.

2.3 Freedom, consent and stopping

The platform is intended to give players freedom to agree on their stakes, pause, resume or stop, provided that their actions are genuine and do not involve fraud or harm to other people. No player may compel another to keep playing. When one player says they want to stop, the request must be respected, and the current standing determines how the inka are divided.

2.4 Mathematics rather than favouritism

The movement of inka is meant to be automatic and governed by one published rule. The platform should apply the same calculation consistently, without an administrator choosing a winner or changing a result in favour of a particular person. The state of the game is tracked move by move, and the inka calculation follows that state.

2.5 Playing first, profit second

The stated goal is to let people play, relax and compete for something small, rather than pressure them to chase wealth. A skilled player doing well is acceptable within the concept, but making players pursue riches is not the objective. This principle should shape the platform’s language, design and later decisions about money-related features.

2.6 A neutral business model

The platform is intended to earn money when inka are purchased and redeemed, not because one particular player wins or loses a match. Since the platform’s revenue would not directly depend on which player wins, the concept argues that it can allow players broad freedom over when to stop or pause. The financial model is described in Sections 6 and 10.

3. The three games and the scope of the concept

3.1 Igisoro

Igisoro is the traditional Rwandan board game played with small pieces placed in pits. It is the most distinctly Rwandan of the three games in the concept. The document identifies Igisoro as one of the platform’s core games, but it does not yet specify the exact board layout, legal moves, or the conditions that define a win in the digital version.

3.2 Dame

Dame is draughts or checkers. In the platform’s proposed version, each player begins with ten pieces, giving twenty pieces on the board in total. Dame is the first game intended to be developed. It is meant to establish the shared platform systems that the later games can reuse.

3.3 Biyari

Biyari refers to billiards in the eight-ball format: the version played with balls that includes the eight ball. The source concept does not yet specify the complete digital table layout, controls, legal shots or win conditions. Those details are to be defined when the game is designed.

3.4 What the concept does and does not specify

The concept establishes that these three games will be available and describes common platform functions such as stakes, settlement, timers, scheduling and live viewing. It does not provide the complete rulebook for each game. The exact board or table layout, legal moves, scoring, how the game ends, and how the game state is converted into an advantage value must be written as part of each game's specification.

The term **inka** has a specific meaning here. In ordinary game contexts it refers to the small playing items such as pieces, seeds or balls; it does not mean cattle. In the platform it also names the unit of play used for stakes and balances.

4. Skill-based, human-versus-human play

The platform is deliberately designed for human-versus-human matches. A player must always face another real user, never an automated opponent. If a user is more experienced at one of the games and wins against another person, the concept treats that as the result of skill.

Players may be strangers. The concept expects users with different levels of experience to meet through matching and scheduling. The possibility of meeting unfamiliar opponents is part of the platform's social value, while the game itself gives them a shared activity.

Outside influence during an active match is intentionally limited. Players do not see spectators' comments while they are playing, because comments could provide advice or distract them. Spectators are not allowed to bet on the result. The server records the game move by move, so the result and the current standing do not depend solely on what a player's phone claims or on the players' own descriptions of what happened.

The founder's position on regulation is described separately in Section 12. The claim that the games are skill-based is a statement of the concept's intention; it does not itself settle how regulators will classify any later version involving money.

5. Finding opponents, availability and scheduling

A platform of this kind is useful only if players can find opponents. The concept therefore includes several ways to connect real people, depending on whether they want to play immediately or arrange a match for later.

5.1 Play now: instant matching

A user chooses a game and taps an option such as "I want to play Igisoro," "I want to play Dame" or "I want to play Biyari." The platform shows other users who have also indicated that they want to play the same game, and it can connect suitable players. If no suitable opponent is available at that moment, the user may propose a time—for example, 3:00 PM—and other interested users may accept.

5.2 Published availability

A user can publish a general time window, such as being available every day from 2:00 PM to 7:00 PM, or can list a particular time on a particular day. The user can also state which game they want to play during that availability. Another user can browse those published availability details, propose a match, and settle on a time if the other person agrees.

5.3 Reminders and call-style alerts

When a scheduled match is due to begin, both players should receive a notification so that each knows the agreed time has arrived. In addition, when a user has said that they are available during a particular period, a new request to play may make their phone ring in a way that resembles an incoming call. The intention is to make the request noticeable rather than easy to miss. The platform itself keeps track of who wants to play and uses that information to connect players.

5.4 Requests from spectators

A person watching a live game may see a player whose skill they admire and send that player a request to play. If the player accepts, the two can arrange a match after the current game ends. The request mechanism is intended to turn live viewing into a way of discovering potential opponents.

5.5 Agreeing the terms before play

Before a match starts, the two players agree how many inka each will stake. They may discuss the proposed amounts through a short chat. They may also choose to speak by phone, and the concept sees these interactions as an opportunity for players to become acquaintances or friends. Sharing a phone number is voluntary.

Several details in this area remain suggestions rather than final rules. One proposed interface would let one player propose a stake and the other choose “Accept,” “Decline” or “Counter,” with a short chat alongside the choice. Another suggestion is to let users restrict who can send requests—for example, by blocking requests from strangers—so that popular players are not overwhelmed. A further suggestion is to use SMS, WhatsApp or email as a fallback if push notifications fail. The exact on-screen design for stake negotiation, scheduling and availability remains open.

6. Inka: the unit of play and value

6.1 Inka balances

Inka are the platform’s unit of value for stakes. Each user has an inka balance in their account. A user who has no inka cannot participate in a match that requires a stake. Before each game, the two players agree how many inka they will put into that match. The concept does not require a player to stake their entire balance; a player may hold many inka or very few and chooses the amount they are willing to put at risk for that game.

6.2 Launch phase: everything is free

At launch, the platform is intended to give users inka without charging them. In practical terms, users may go through a process described as “buying” inka, but no payment would be collected during this phase. Playing, using inka and watching live games would all be free. The purpose of this phase is to allow the platform to build a community before real-money payments are introduced.

One detail remains undecided: the number of free inka a new user will receive, and whether there will be a cap on free inka. The concept does not specify a final amount.

6.3 Later phase: buying and redeeming inka

In a later phase, users would be able to purchase inka with real money through payment channels such as MTN Mobile Money, Airtel Money and other licensed money-transfer providers. The proposed model uses two fixed prices. The platform sells an inka at one fixed price and redeems it at a lower fixed price. The difference is intended to be the platform’s revenue.

The source document gives an illustration, not a final price: an inka might be purchased for 100 units of money and redeemed for 80. The 20-unit difference would be the gross spread before applicable operating costs. The actual prices would be set later. Only the platform would sell or redeem inka. Users would not be permitted to trade or sell inka directly to one another.

Because the purchase and redemption prices would remain fixed, the concept does not intend inka to become a speculative asset. Users would not earn money simply by trading inka with other users or by holding them. The stated purpose of inka is to enable play. Under this model, the platform’s income would arise when users buy and redeem inka, rather than from the outcome of a particular match.

6.4 Money-transfer costs

The founder's view, as recorded in the source concept, is that sending money through mobile-money services is inexpensive and may become cheaper as digital payments expand, while cashing out can cost more. The source gives rough illustrative estimates: transferring about RWF 2,000,000 might cost around RWF 200 in fees, while cashing out a comparable value in inka might cost around RWF 5,000. These numbers are estimates from the concept discussion, not verified provider quotations, and must be checked with the relevant payment providers before they are used for planning.

The concept argues that the difference between purchase and redemption prices, together with withdrawal costs, may discourage people from abusing the system. However, the final responsibility for mobile-money fees remains undecided: it is still open whether the platform or the user would pay them.

6.5 Controls around inka

The founder considers it unlikely that users would use the platform to store very large amounts of wealth as inka. Nevertheless, the concept recognises that authorities may have the power to investigate suspicious activity and, where legally authorised, freeze or remove inka in a manner comparable to action involving bank accounts.

Suggested controls include verifying a user's identity with a national ID and phone number before allowing redemption for money, setting daily limits on how many inka a user can redeem, and displaying both the purchase and redemption prices clearly before a user makes a purchase. These controls are suggestions to be confirmed and designed; they are not described as already implemented.

7. Stakes, advantage and settlement mathematics

This is the central operating mechanism of the concept. It explains how each player's stake is agreed, how inka move during play, and what happens when a match ends, is paused or is interrupted.

7.1 Agreeing the stakes

Before the game, the two players agree how many inka each will stake. They may stake equal amounts, such as five inka each, or different amounts, such as five for one player and three for the other, or ten for one player and three for the other. The amounts are determined by agreement between the players rather than by a single platform-wide fixed stake.

The concept intentionally permits unequal stakes. A player with a large balance can play against someone with a smaller balance, provided both agree on their respective stakes. If one player chooses to stake substantially more than the other, that player does so knowingly. The concept does not propose to rebalance the stakes or reduce a player's potential win merely because the stakes are unequal. If the player with the smaller stake wins, the concept treats that as a legitimate win against a confident opponent.

Only the amount staked is at risk. The rest of a player's inka balance is untouched by that game. A player cannot lose more inka than the amount they have put into the match.

7.2 Gradual movement during play

The platform follows the state of the match continuously. As one player gains an advantage, inka gradually move from the player who is behind to the player who is ahead. At every moment, the platform therefore has a current standing for the two players. That standing is used to settle the game if someone stops, if the players pause, if a player disconnects and does not return in time, or if the game reaches its normal end.

7.3 The mathematical settlement rule

Let **a** represent Player A's original stake and **b** represent Player B's original stake. The total pool is **a + b**. At the start, each player's share of the pool is exactly their own stake: A has a and B has b. The variable **w** represents the advantage of the player who is ahead. It ranges from 0, when the players are level, to 1, when the leader has achieved a complete win.

> For Player A when A is leading:
>
> **A's current holding = a + (w × b)**
> **B's current holding = b × (1 − w)**
>
> Equivalently, A's share of the total pool is a/(a+b) + w × b/(a+b). If B is leading instead, the roles are reversed.

In plain language, the leading player receives a fraction *w* of the other player's stake. The player who is behind loses exactly that amount. Nothing else in either player's account is affected. This makes the current division depend on both the original stakes and the game's measured advantage.

7.4 What the formula is intended to guarantee

First, it gives both players a fair starting point under the concept's own definition: when w = 0, each person holds exactly their own stake. If they start a match and stop immediately, neither has gained anything from the other. The concept therefore says a separate minimum-number-of-moves rule is not needed to prevent someone from starting a match, taking inka and leaving at once.

Second, the formula allows unequal stakes to remain unequal without adding an extra adjustment. A player who stakes more can win or lose more, but only up to the other player's actual stake. Third, movement is meant to be steady: each equal increase in the advantage measure changes the inka holding by an equal amount. There is no special sudden jump near the end merely because a player appears close to victory. A player who seems nearly beaten may still recover.

Finally, if w reaches 1, the leader receives the whole pool, consisting of their own stake plus the opponent's stake. A player can never take more from an opponent than that opponent originally staked.

7.5 Worked examples

Player A stake	Player B stake	Leader and w	A currently holds	B currently holds	Explanation
5	5	A; w = 0.2	6.0	4.0	A has gained 1 inka.
5	5	A; w = 0.5	7.5	2.5	A has gained half of B's stake.
4	5	B; w = 0.4	2.4	6.6	B gains 0.4 × 4 = 1.6; A loses 1.6.
3	10	A; w = 0.5	8.0	5.0	A moves from 3 to 8, gaining 5 from B.
3	10	A; w = 1.0	13.0	0.0	A wins the entire pool despite staking less.
3	10	B; w = 0.5	1.5	11.5	B gains 1.5, which is half of A's stake.
3	10	B; w = 1.0	0.0	13.0	B wins the entire pool.

The source concept suggests that inka may need to be represented in fractional amounts, such as hundredths of an inka, so that repeated calculations do not lose value through rounding. The exact internal precision and rounding policy remain a technical detail to be specified.

7.6 Measuring the advantage value w

Each game needs its own method for translating the current state of play into the value **w**. The settlement formula is intended to stay the same across all games, while the measurement of advantage changes according to the game.

For the first game, Dame, the source concept gives an example based on pieces captured. Each player starts with ten pieces. If Player A has captured three of B's pieces and Player B has captured one of A's pieces, A has a net advantage of two pieces out of ten, and the example assigns w = 0.2. This is an illustrative starting rule; the complete mapping from every possible board position to w still needs to be specified.

All Dame pieces are treated as equal in the platform's inka calculation, including a piece that has become a king (called a "dame" in the source). A king is not assigned extra numerical value. Its practical strength is expected to be expressed through the player's ability to capture more pieces. The platform is not supposed to predict who is about to win or award inka in advance; it counts what has actually happened, because the opponent may still recover.

An open requirement is that a decisive Dame win—when all of one side's pieces are captured or blocked—must always produce w = 1. The final formula must guarantee that endpoint. For Igisoro, the source offers a candidate measure: let p be the fraction of all pieces held by a player and calculate $w = |2p - 1|$. This is only a candidate for later specification, not a final confirmed rule. The measure for Biyari, perhaps based on balls potted, is not yet defined.

7.7 Changing stakes after the match begins

The concept allows stake changes during a game because it values freedom where the activity is genuine and harmless. The general principle is that once a match has started, a change that affects the other player should require that player's agreement. If the players cannot agree, a player acting alone can stop the match, and the other person cannot prevent that stop.

The source records several proposed rules, but marks them as needing confirmation. Raising one's own stake might not require the opponent's approval because it increases the amount the opponent could win. Lowering one's own stake would require approval because it would reduce what the opponent could win. If both players raise or lower their stakes, both would need to agree. The treatment of already-moved inka also remains open. One suggested approach is that inka already transferred remain transferred, while the new stake applies from the moment of the change onward. These approval and accounting rules must be confirmed before implementation.

7.8 Stopping and pausing

Any player may stop at any moment. For example, if a player stakes ten inka and the opponent has already gained five, the first player may decide to stop rather than continue. The match ends and each player keeps the amount shown by the current standing. The player who is ahead keeps the inka already won; the player who is behind keeps whatever remains in their current holding.

Neither player can force the other to continue until the board reaches a final result. This is intended to respect the right to leave while still preserving the settlement already produced by the game. The concept also permits a pause by mutual agreement. The players may resume later, even on the following day, and the source concept says either may add or withdraw inka before continuing. The exact handling of these changes needs to align with the unresolved stake-change rules above.

7.9 Disconnection and return period

The platform is expected to keep track of the match if a phone switches off, a data bundle runs out or the connection otherwise fails. A disconnected player receives a grace period in which to return. If the player does not return before that period ends, the platform pays out the current standing. The opponent receives the inka already won, while any remaining amount stays with the account to which it belongs.

After the grace period, the player who stayed connected may end the game or choose to wait for the other player and continue if they return. Switching off a phone is not intended to erase a loss that has already occurred through

the gradual movement of inka; equally, a player who is ahead does not lose what they have already gained merely because the opponent disappears. The length of the grace period is open. A range of 60 to 120 seconds was suggested, but no final duration has been chosen.

7.10 Slow-play timer

A player who takes more than thirty seconds to make a move is intended to lose some inka as a penalty. The source concept explains that a long delay may be stalling or may indicate that the player is seeking advice from someone or something outside the game. It can also spoil the pace for the opponent. The amount of the penalty depends on the particular game and has not yet been fixed.

Suggested interface details include a visible countdown and a warning during the final ten seconds, so that a player is not caught unaware. A slow move should be treated differently from a lost connection: a connection failure uses the grace period described above. The final penalty amounts and whether the thirty-second limit should differ between Igisoro, Dame and Biyari remain open.

8. Live games and spectators

8.1 Public live games

Players may choose to play a match live, meaning that other users can watch it while it is happening. Live viewing is intended to be free. In the public view, players are identified by their names rather than photographs. Small drawings or avatars may be used on profiles, but the live game itself does not display player photographs.

8.2 What spectators can do

Spectators can watch the board and the current standing. They can write comments and chat with other spectators, and those comments are visible to the spectator community. A spectator who admires a player’s skill can also request to play that player. If the player accepts, the match can be arranged after the current game has finished. This may lead to new acquaintances or friendships.

8.3 What players see during a match

Players see the board and their running standing, meaning the amount of inka they currently hold or have gained or lost through the match. They do not see the spectators’ comments while the game is in progress. This rule is intended to keep players focused and, more importantly, prevent spectators from feeding them strategic advice while they are playing.

After the match, players may read the comments that spectators wrote about the game. The concept anticipates that these comments may include praise, encouragement or observations about a player’s skill. The source says the comment visibility rule should be the same for everyone; it does not propose a setting that allows an individual player to switch comments on or off during the match.

8.4 Spectator betting is excluded

An earlier version of the idea allowed spectators to place inka on which player they thought would win, without the players seeing the bets. That feature has been removed from the current concept. The source gives two main reasons. First, betting on someone else’s result does not itself demonstrate skill and could make the overall platform look like gambling to a regulator. Second, it could create an opportunity for collusion: a player might deliberately lose so that friends who bet against them would profit. Such behaviour would be difficult to supervise and could cost other users their inka.

The founder may reconsider spectator betting much later, but only after legal clearance and with strong anti-cheating controls. Under the present concept, spectators may watch, comment and request to play; they may not bet on the match.

8.5 Advertising on and around live games

The live game page is intended to remain free of advertisements so that players can concentrate on the game. Advertising is planned for other pages of the platform. This distinction is part of the business model, not an accidental design choice.

8.6 Suggestions for growing live viewing

Several enhancements are suggested but are not yet final requirements. A “Live now” page could show matches in progress and how many people are watching each match. Users could share a live game through WhatsApp with a message such as “I’m playing—come and watch.” A short delay of a few seconds between the players’ actions and what spectators see could make it harder for someone outside the game to pass live advice to a player.

Other suggestions include leaderboards showing highly skilled players, scheduled events such as a weekly final announced in advance, and moderation tools that let users report comments, mute other users or remove disruptive participants. It is also suggested that players be able to limit who can send them requests and how many requests they receive.

9. Profiles and community

The concept presents the platform as a way for people to connect through games while keeping identity display simple. Players appear by name during matches; photographs are not shown in the live game. Profiles may use a small illustrated avatar instead of a photograph.

Players who enjoy one another’s company may choose to speak by phone, share contact details voluntarily and become friends. Contact details are not meant to be shared automatically or without permission.

Suggested profile information includes a username, an avatar drawing, games played and won, a level or rank, the games the user plays, the user’s published availability, and a button to request a match. Suggested registration fields are a username, phone number and password. Other proposed community features include lists of followed users, notifications when favourite players go live, and block and report tools for every user.

The source also suggests that any feature involving real money should be restricted to adults aged eighteen or older. This is a proposed safeguard to be checked against applicable law and the final operating model; it is not a statement that the current concept has already completed age verification.

10. Business model and revenue

At launch, the platform is intended to be free to use. The concept proposes two principal revenue sources, with two additional possible sources that are suggestions rather than confirmed parts of the model.

10.1 Revenue from the inka price spread

When the paid phase begins, the platform would sell inka at a fixed price and redeem them at a lower fixed price. The difference between those prices is the intended revenue source. The source’s illustration is a purchase price of 100 and a redemption price of 80, producing a spread of 20 per inka before costs. The actual prices are not set. Because the spread is built into buying and redeeming, the platform’s revenue would not depend on the result of a particular match.

10.2 Advertising

Advertising is the other stated revenue source. Ads may appear on all pages except the live game page, which is intended to remain uncluttered so that players can concentrate. The source concept indicates that advertising could operate from launch, even while the games and inka are free.

10.3 Possible sponsorship

Sponsorship is suggested as a possible later revenue stream once the platform has a substantial audience. Mobile networks, banks or other brands might sponsor the platform, an event or a tournament. One suggested format is a discreet message such as “game presented by…” placed outside the board area, rather than interrupting the game itself. Sponsorship is not yet a confirmed requirement.

10.4 Optional cosmetic extras

Another suggestion is to offer optional cosmetic items, such as board colours or themes, that users could buy with inka. These would change appearance rather than the underlying game rules. This idea remains a suggestion and would need further definition.

The overall sequence is therefore free use first, followed by the introduction of paid inka features later. The source concept does not set a launch date for the paid phase.

11. Fair play, fraud prevention and user safety

The founder’s stated approach is to allow as much freedom as possible when people are acting genuinely, while preventing fraud and harm to other users. The source concept identifies several risks and records responses, some of which are confirmed design principles and some of which are suggestions for additional controls.

11.1 Collusion or moving value through intentional losses

Two people might agree outside the platform to transfer value between themselves. For example, one could deliberately lose a match so that the other receives inka and later redeems them. The source concept argues that the difference between the buying and redemption prices, together with mobile-money fees, would make such activity less attractive. It also notes that authorities may investigate or freeze suspicious accounts where legally authorised.

Suggested extra controls include monitoring accounts that repeatedly play and lose to one another, setting daily redemption limits, and requiring identity verification before redemption.

11.2 Use of stolen mobile money

A further risk is that stolen mobile money could be used to purchase inka and then passed to an accomplice through games. The source proposes the same general controls: identity verification, monitoring and appropriate action by payment partners or authorities where the law permits.

11.3 Multiple accounts and playing oneself

A person might attempt to create multiple accounts and play against themselves. Suggested controls include linking one account to a phone number and identity, together with monitoring for suspicious account patterns. These controls are proposals to be designed and checked against privacy and legal requirements.

11.4 Computer-assisted play

A player might use a program that suggests moves, similar to computer assistance sometimes seen in chess. The source records this as a long-term concern worth planning for early. Suggested responses include detecting implausibly accurate play or suspicious timing patterns and using the move timer. The concept does not yet specify a detection algorithm.

11.5 Coaching from outside the match

A friend or spectator might try to tell a player what to do during a live match. The confirmed design principle is that players cannot see spectator comments while they are playing. A short broadcast delay is also suggested to reduce the possibility of spectators passing real-time information.

11.6 Quitting to escape a loss

A losing player might switch off their phone to avoid the outcome. The gradual settlement rule is intended to address this: the current standing is paid out after the disconnection grace period. Switching off a phone does not undo inka that have already moved.

11.7 Starting and immediately stopping

A player might try to begin a game, gain inka and stop immediately. Under the formula, each player starts with exactly their own stake, so stopping at once changes nothing. The source therefore says a minimum number of moves is not required for this specific protection.

11.8 Stalling

A player might deliberately delay moves. The proposed response is a thirty-second timer and an inka penalty for taking too long. The amount of the penalty remains open and may differ by game.

11.9 Abusive spectator comments

Spectators may insult players or one another. Reporting, muting and removal tools are suggested so disruptive conduct can be addressed. The source concept does not yet specify a full moderation policy or how long comments should be retained.

A key technical principle underpins these responses: the server, not the players' phones, is the authority for what happened. Every move should be stored so that the match history can be checked.

12. Legal and regulatory considerations

The founder's position in the source concept is that the games are based on skill, that there are no bots, and that spectators do not bet. The priority is to complete the concept and build the platform, while meeting regulatory requirements when the relevant authorities identify them. The concept says legal detail should not prevent the idea from being documented and developed as a concept.

At the same time, the source records an important caution: this document is not legal advice. Once inka can be purchased with real money and redeemed for money, and users can gain or lose inka through games, a regulator may examine whether the service is a skill competition, gambling or another regulated activity. The boundary can differ between countries. Calling a game skill-based does not by itself determine its legal classification.

The source therefore recommends obtaining advice from a Rwandan lawyer or consulting the relevant regulator before real money is introduced. Beginning with free inka is intended to postpone the real-money question until the platform is ready, but it does not remove the need to examine the applicable rules before activating paid features.

Suggested compliance measures include identity verification and anti-money-laundering checks in cooperation with mobile-money partners before money redemption, compliance with Rwanda's personal-data protection rules, and age restrictions for money-related features. The regulatory route and any licences or approvals required remain open questions. These issues must be resolved with qualified legal and regulatory guidance, rather than assumed to be settled by the concept document.

13. Technical considerations

The following points are implementation suggestions derived from the concept. They are recorded to preserve the intended behaviour, but the source does not claim that these technical choices have already been made or built.

13.1 Server-authoritative game logic

The game logic should run on the server, while players' phones send their moves. The server would decide whether a move is valid, update the board and calculate the current standing. This is intended to reduce opportunities to alter results from a user's device.

13.2 Recording moves and match history

Every move should be stored. A complete move history could allow a game to be resumed after a disconnection or pause, replayed if there is a dispute, and reviewed if suspicious behaviour is detected.

13.3 Real-time communication

Live play and live viewing require real-time communication between the server and users. The source gives WebSockets as an example of a technology that could support this. The specific technology is a technical choice to be made during implementation.

13.4 An inka ledger

Every movement of inka should be recorded as an entry in a ledger. Rather than relying only on a mutable displayed balance, the system could calculate balances from recorded entries. Exact fractional units would help prevent value being lost through rounding.

13.5 Settlement engine and timers

A settlement engine should continually calculate the advantage value w for each active game and apply the formula in Section 7. Server-side timers should enforce the thirty-second move rule and the disconnection grace period. Keeping the timing on the server is intended to make the rules consistent for both players.

13.6 Notifications, mobile data and language

The platform should support scheduled reminders and call-style alerts, with SMS, WhatsApp or email suggested as fallbacks if push notifications fail. Because some users may have expensive or limited mobile data, pages and live viewing should be fast and economical. The design should be mobile-first. Kinyarwanda is suggested as the primary interface language, with English and French available as options.

13.7 Payments, administration and moderation

MTN Mobile Money, Airtel Money and other suitable payment providers would be connected when the paid phase begins, rather than being required for the initial free launch. Administration tools should support reports, fraud monitoring and user assistance. Moderation tools would support reporting, muting and removal of disruptive users, subject to the final policy.

14. Development sequence

The concept calls for the idea to be completed and agreed in full before development begins. The source explicitly rejects the idea of creating a reduced or "cut-down" version that omits parts of the concept. The intent is to document the complete platform first, then build it in a planned sequence.

Dame is the first game to be developed. It would establish shared systems for user accounts, finding opponents, agreeing stakes, settlement, live viewing and other common platform functions. Igisoro and Biyari would then reuse those shared components, while each receives its own rules and method for calculating advantage.

The launch should be free. Inka would be supplied without payment, and all platform use—including live viewing—would be free. Payment integrations, identity checks and redemption functions would be introduced later, when the platform moves into the paid phase and after the applicable legal and regulatory questions have been addressed.

The detailed rules for each game are to be written as that game is built. The concept therefore distinguishes between defining the overall platform behaviour now and specifying each game's full board, moves and win conditions during its game-specific design.

15. Open questions that remain unresolved

The following questions are explicitly left open in the source concept. They are included here because a detailed document should make the remaining decisions visible rather than silently invent answers.

No.	Open question	Why it matters
1	What will the platform's final name and brand be?	The current title is only a working title.
2	How many free inka will a new user receive, and will free inka be capped?	This affects onboarding and the initial user experience.
3	What will the final purchase price, redemption price and daily redemption limits be?	These affect the business model, user understanding and controls.
4	How long will the disconnection grace period last?	The source suggests 60–120 seconds, but no final duration is chosen.
5	What is the slow-play penalty for each game, and does the 30-second limit differ by game?	The timing and penalty must be specified consistently.
6	How exactly will w be calculated for each game, and how will a decisive win guarantee w = 1?	The settlement formula depends on a reliable game-specific measure.
7	How will stake changes during a game be approved and accounted for?	The concept has suggested principles but asks for confirmation.
8	What will the screen design for stake negotiation, availability and scheduling look like?	The interaction flow remains unspecified.
9	Who may send requests to a player, and how many requests can they receive?	This affects privacy, convenience and harassment prevention.
10	Will the platform include ranks, levels, leaderboards or tournaments?	Some are suggestions, not confirmed features.
11	Who pays mobile-money transaction fees?	The concept has not assigned the cost to the platform or user.
12	What registration and verification information is required, and what age rules apply?	This must be designed with legal and privacy requirements in mind.
13	What is the regulatory route, and which licences or approvals may be required?	Real-money features must not rely on assumptions about legal status.
14	Which interface languages will be available?	Kinyarwanda, English and French are suggested, but final scope is open.
15	What is the moderation policy, and how long are comments retained?	Reporting, removal and data retention rules need definition.
16	What are the detailed rules and board/table layouts for Dame, Igisoro and Biyari?	The concept identifies the games but not their complete digital rulebooks.

Appendix A. Example of a typical user session

The following invented example shows how the parts of the concept might work together. The names, stakes and game-state numbers are illustrative, not final product settings.

After work, Habimana opens the platform and chooses “I want to play Dame.” The platform shows him four other people who have also indicated that they want to play Dame. It also shows that Uwase has published availability between 6:00 PM and 9:00 PM. Habimana sends a request, and Uwase receives an alert that rings her phone like an incoming call.

Uwase opens the request and they chat briefly. Habimana proposes a stake of five inka. Uwase counters with three. They agree that Habimana will stake five and Uwase will stake three, making a total pool of eight inka. They choose to play live, so spectators can watch the match.

Twelve people watch the game and exchange comments. Habimana and Uwase see the board and their running standing, but they do not see the spectators’ comments while they play. This allows the spectators to discuss the match without feeding advice to the players.

After twenty minutes, Uwase has the advantage value w = 0.3. Under the formula, Uwase’s original stake was three and Habimana’s was five. As the leader, Uwase holds 3 + (0.3 × 5) = 4.5 inka. Habimana holds 5 × (1 – 0.3) = 3.5 inka. Together their holdings still total eight.

Habimana decides that he wants to stop. Uwase cannot force him to continue, and the platform settles the game according to the current standing. Uwase has gained 1.5 inka over her original stake, and Habimana has lost 1.5 from his original stake. Each retains the balance shown by the formula.

After the match, the players can read the spectators’ comments. Kamali, one of the spectators, thought Uwase played particularly well and sends her a request to play. If Uwase accepts, they can arrange another match after her current game has ended. The example illustrates how play, the gradual settlement rule, public viewing, comments and requests to play fit together.

Appendix B. Glossary

Term	Meaning in this concept
Igisoro	Traditional Rwandan board game played with small pieces in pits.
Dame	Draughts/checkers; each side starts with ten pieces in the proposed platform version.
Biyari	Billiards in the eight-ball format.
Inka	The small playing items in these games and the platform’s unit for stakes and account balances; not cattle.
Stake	The amount of inka a player agrees to put into a particular game.
Pool	The combined total of both players’ stakes, a + b.
Advantage (w)	A value from 0 (players level) to 1 (complete win) used to measure how far ahead the leader is.
Standing	The current division of the inka pool between the players at a particular moment.
Settlement	Applying the current standing when a game stops, pauses, is interrupted or finishes.
Spread	The difference between the price at which inka are bought and the lower price at which they are redeemed.
Live/public game	A game that other users are allowed to watch while it is in progress.
Spectator	A user who watches a live game rather than playing in it.

Term	Meaning in this concept
Grace period	The time allowed for a disconnected player to return before the current standing is paid out.
KYC	“Know Your Customer”: identity verification used by a service before allowing certain transactions.

Appendix C. Decision log

This log summarises the principal decisions recorded in the source concept. It is intended as a quick reference; it does not replace the detailed explanations in the main sections.

1. The platform will offer online multiplayer versions of Igisoro, Dame and Biyari; complete game-specific rules are to be written later.

2. Every match is between real people. There are no bots or computer opponents, and the concept is framed around games of skill.

3. Users can request a game immediately, schedule a game, publish availability, and receive reminders when a match is due.

4. A person who publishes availability may receive a call-style alert when someone requests a game.

5. Every game uses inka. The two players agree their stakes, and the stakes do not need to be equal.

6. Unequal stakes remain as agreed. A leader can win at most the opponent’s stake, and the platform does not apply an additional adjustment to make unequal stakes equal.

7. Inka move gradually according to the settlement formula, using equal increments of the advantage measure rather than accelerating near the end.

8. Each player starts with their own stake. Starting and immediately stopping a game changes nothing.

9. Any player may stop at any time and keep their current holding. No one can force the other player to continue.

10. Players may pause by mutual agreement and resume later; the source also contemplates adding or withdrawing inka when they resume, subject to final rules.

11. If a player disconnects, they receive a grace period. If they do not return, the current standing is paid out and the connected player may end the match or wait.

12. A player taking more than thirty seconds over a move is intended to receive an inka penalty; the penalty depends on the game and remains to be specified.

13. In Dame, each side starts with ten pieces, and all pieces—including kings—are equal in the platform’s calculation.

14. Dame is the first game to be developed and is intended to provide the foundation for the other games.

15. Live games display player names, not photographs. Profiles may use small drawings or avatars.

16. Spectators comment among themselves. Players do not see those comments during a match but may read them afterward.

17. Spectators can request to play a player whose skill they admire.

18. Spectator betting is removed from the current concept. It may only be reconsidered much later with legal clearance and anti-cheating controls.

19. Inka are free at launch. Later they may be bought at a fixed price and redeemed at a lower fixed price; 100 and 80 are only an illustration.

20. Only the platform may sell or redeem inka. Users may not trade inka directly with one another.

21. The stated revenue model is the inka price spread and advertising on every page except the live game page.

22. The founder’s view is that transaction fees and withdrawal costs, together with authorities’ powers, may make misuse unattractive; legal and regulatory work remains necessary before real-money features.

23. Everything is free during the launch phase, including live viewing.

24. The concept should be completed and agreed in full before development; the source rejects a reduced version that leaves out parts of the idea.